

Clinical Study Summary Report (CSSR)

Document Status: Final | Version: 1.0 | Date: 01-APR-2026

1. Administrative & Study Identification

Full Study Title:	A Phase 3, Randomized Study to Compare Nemtabrutinib Versus Comparator (Investigator's Choice of Ibrutinib or Acalabrutinib) in Participants With Untreated Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia/Small Lymphocytic Lymphoma (BELLWAVE-011)
Short Title:	A Study of Nemtabrutinib (MK-1026) Versus Comparator (Investigator's Choice of Ibrutinib or Acalabrutinib) in First Line (1L) Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia (CLL)/ Small Lymphocytic Lymphoma (SLL) (MK-1026-011/BELLWAVE-011)
Protocol Number:	174625704526148568
NCT Number:	NCT06136559
Sponsor Name:	Merck
Investigational Product:	ibrutinib
Phase:	PHASE3
Medical Monitor:	[Not Provided in Posting]

2. Study Synopsis & Rationale

2.1 Study Objective

Primary Objective:	1. Objective Response Rate (ORR) per Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia (iwCLL) Criteria 2018 as assessed by Blinded Independent Central Review (BICR): ORR is defined as the percentage of participants with complete response (CR), complete response with an incomplete recovery of the participant's bone marrow (CRI), nodular partial response (nPR), or partial response (PR), per iwCLL Criteria 2018 as assessed by BICR. 2. Progression-Free Survival (PFS) per iwCLL Criteria 2018 as assessed by BICR: PFS is defined as the time from randomization to the first documented progressive disease (PD) or death due to any cause, whichever occurs first. PD is evaluated per iwCLL Criteria 2018 as assessed by BICR.
Secondary Obj.:	1. Overall Survival (OS) 2. Duration of Response (DOR) per iwCLL Criteria 2018 as assessed by BICR 3. Number of Participants Who Experience One or More Adverse Events (AEs)

2.2 Background & Rationale

The goal of this study is to evaluate nemtabrutinib compared with investigator's choice of ibrutinib or acalabrutinib in participants with chronic lymphocytic leukemia (CLL)/small lymphocytic lymphoma (SLL) who have not received any prior therapy. The primary hypotheses are that (1) nemtabrutinib is non-inferior to ibrutinib or acalabrutinib with respect to objective response rate (ORR) per International Workshop on Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia (iwCLL) Criteria 2018 by blinded independent central review (BICR) and (2) nemtabrutinib is superior to ibrutinib or acalabrutinib with respect to progression free survival (PFS) per iwCLL Criteria 2018 by BICR.

3. Study Design & Methodology

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Design Framework: Type: INTERVENTIONAL, Phase: PHASE3, Status: RECRUITING
Target N: 1200

4. Subject Selection (Eligibility Criteria)

4.1 Inclusion Criteria

The main inclusion criteria include but are not limited to the following:

- * Confirmed diagnosis of CLL/SLL and active disease clearly documented to have a need to initiate therapy.
- * Has at least 1 marker of disease burden.
- * Has an Eastern Cooperative Oncology Group (ECOG) performance status of 0 to 2 within 7 days before randomization.
- * Has the ability to swallow and retain oral medication.
- * Participants who are hepatitis B surface antigen (HBsAg) positive are eligible if they have received hepatitis B virus (HBV) antiviral therapy for at least 4 weeks and have undetectable HBV deoxyribonucleic acid (DNA) viral load before randomization.
- * Participants with history of hepatitis C virus (HCV) infection are eligible if HCV ribonucleic acid (RNA) viral load is undetectable at screening.
- * Participants with human immunodeficiency virus (HIV) who meet ALL eligibility criteria.

4.2 Exclusion Criteria

The main exclusion criteria include but are not limited to the following:

- * Has an active hepatitis B virus/ hepatitis C virus (HBV/HCV) infection.
- * Has gastrointestinal (GI) dysfunction that may affect drug absorption.
- * Has diagnosis of Richter Transformation or active central nervous system (CNS) involvement by CLL/SLL.
- * Has had acquired immune deficiency syndrome (AIDS)-defining opportunistic infection in the past 12 months before screening.
- * Has clinically significant cardiovascular disease.
- * Has hypersensitivity to nemtabrutinib or contraindication to ibrutinib or acalabrutinib, or any of the excipients.
- * Has history of severe bleeding disorder.
- * Has known additional malignancy that is progressing or has required active treatment within the past 2 years.
- * Has received any systemic anticancer therapy for CLL/SLL.
- * Is currently being treated with p-glycoprotein (P-gp) substrates with a narrow therapeutic index, cytochrome P450 3A (CYP3A) strong or moderate inducers or CYP3A strong inhibitors.
- * Received prior radiotherapy within 2 weeks of start of study intervention, or radiation-related toxicities, requiring corticosteroids.
- * Received a live or live-attenuated vaccine within 30 days before the first dose of study intervention. Administration of killed vaccines are allowed.
- * Has received an investigational agent or has used an investigational device within 4 weeks before study intervention administration.

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- * Has active infection requiring systemic therapy, including intravenous (IV) antibiotics during screening.
- * Participants who have not adequately recovered from major surgery or have ongoing surgical complications.

11. Study Identifiers & Governance

Primary ID: 174625704526148568

Registry Number: NCT06136559

Sponsor: Merck

Study Title: A Study of Nemtabrutinib (MK-1026) Versus Comparator (Investigator's Choice of Ibrutinib or Acalabrutinib) in First Line (1L) Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia (CLL)/ Small Lymphocytic Lymphoma (SLL) (MK-1026-011/BELLWAVE-011)

15. Sign-off & Approval

Principal Investigator: _____ Date: _____

Clinical Operations Lead: _____ Date: _____

Lead Statistician: _____ Date: _____